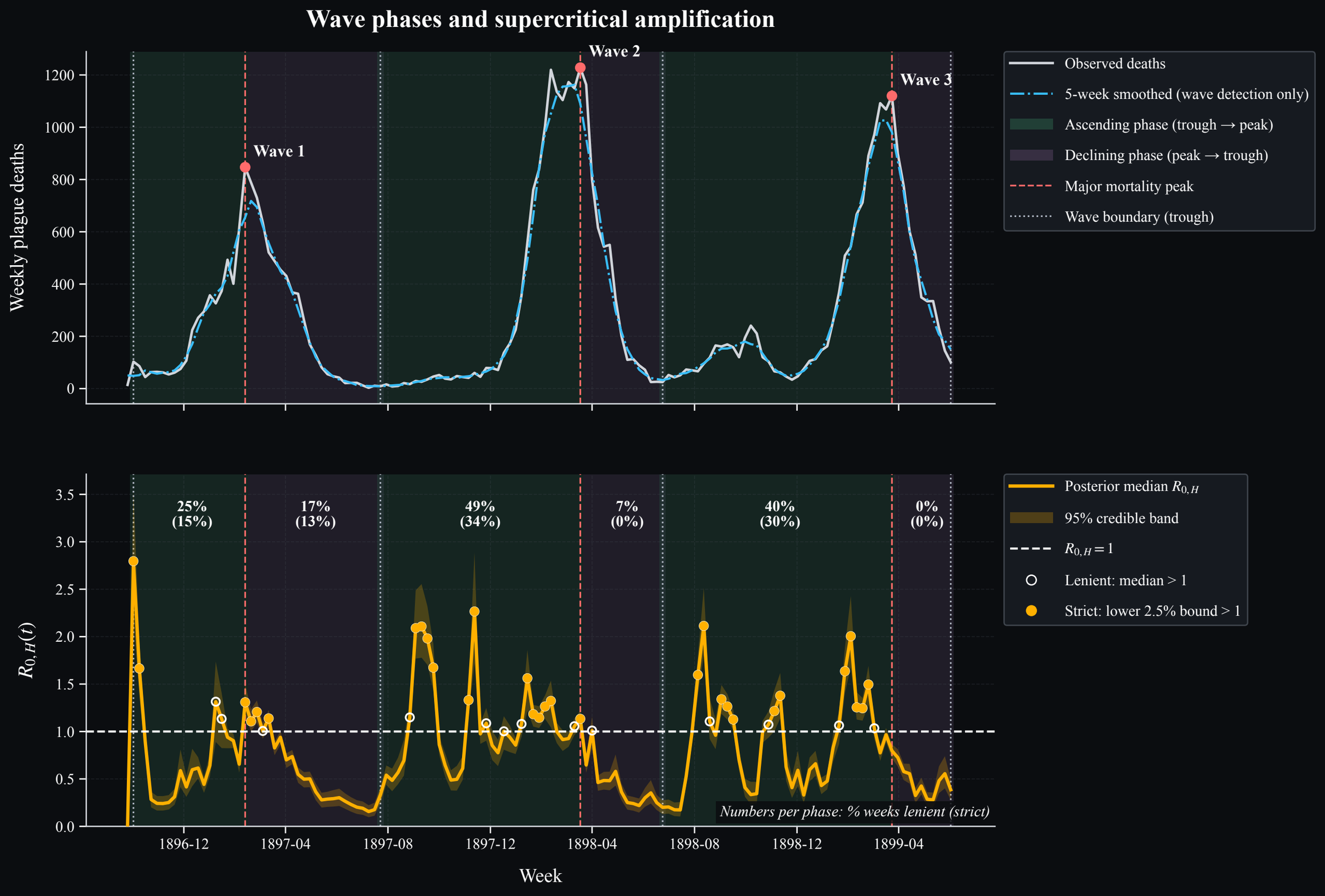

Wave phases and supercritical amplification
Wave 1
Wave 2
Wave 3
Weekly plague deaths
0
200
400
600
800
1000
1200
Observed deaths
5-week smoothed (wave detection only)
Ascending phase (trough → peak)
Declining phase (peak → trough)
Major mortality peak
Wave boundary (trough)
25%
(15%)
17%
(13%)
49%
(34%)
7%
(0%)
40%
(30%)
0%
(0%)
$R_{0,H}(t)$
0.0
0.5
1.0
1.5
2.0
2.5
3.0
3.5
Posterior median $R_{0,H}$
95% credible band
$R_{0,H} = 1$
Lenient: median > 1
Strict: lower 2.5% bound > 1
Numbers per phase: % weeks lenient (strict)
1896-12
1897-04
1897-08
1897-12
1898-04
1898-08
1898-12
1899-04
Week